

5 Things about Windows...

...that You'll Never Miss Again

Common Windows tasks that you can now do in Linux

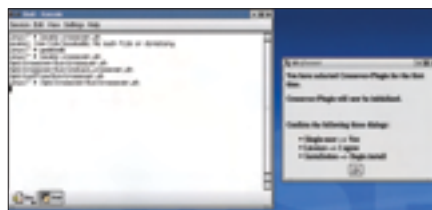
Only a few computer enthusiasts, and hobbyists look upon Linux as an alternative operating system. However, this scenario has been changing drastically. Now, ordinary users use Linux for typical desktop use such as word processing, making presentations, and listening to music. This is possible due to the availability of free as well as commercial office applications for Linux that offer good compatibility with existing MS Office files. But, there are times when something as simple as sharing a file with your friends across a LAN, or a printer configuration, can get confusing due to the lack of any coherent information source. This workshop helps you get around those small, irritating hiccups that stand in the way of using Linux to its fullest potential.

1 Use Windows Programs in Linux with CrossOver Office

Ever thought how nice it would be if you could install Microsoft Office in Linux? Well, here's your dream come true. CrossOver Office is a Windows emulator

that installs your favourite Windows program, under Linux. This program has an ever-growing list of supported software.

We installed CrossOver office on Suse Desktop Linux, by executing a shell script. This shell executable is located in the `/opt/cxoffice` folder. As soon as you



Run the `crossover.sh` script at the prompt to start the installation

execute the command: `/opt/cxoffice/bin/crossover.sh`, the emulator starts installing. The script starts uncompressing the files, and installing them. During this process, it asks you to configure the proxy settings—since this utility has the capability to download files from the Internet, if necessary.

Once the installation of CrossOver Office is complete, install all your



Configure the proxy settings, if you are behind a firewall

favourite Windows programs such as Microsoft Office 2000, IE 5 or 5.5, Photoshop 7, Visio 2000, etc.

As soon as you click on Microsoft Office 2000, in the CrossOver Office install window, a new window pops up where you need to specify the source location of the set up files, for example, `/mnt/cdrom`, to install the application via a CD.

The installation starts just like it would have on a Windows PC, asking you the serial key, license agreement,